

hackathon participant guide

everything you need. read this before you show up.

Table of Contents

1. [TL;DR](#)
2. [Must Haves](#)
3. [Code of Conduct](#)
4. [Rules](#)
5. [Before You Show Up](#)
6. [Team Formation](#)
7. [Submission Guide](#)
8. [Sponsor Tools & Credits](#)
9. [Catering](#)
10. [Quick Reference Card](#)

1. TL;DR

- **When:** 1 days (25.7)
- **Where:** Infomotion office, 4th floor, Friedrichstr 6, 70174 Stuttgart
- **Communication:** [Discord](#)
- **Teams:** 1–4 people. Group work is highly encouraged. Use discord for team formation.
- **Deadline:** 16:30 (Recommended to stop development by 16:00).
- **What you submit:** A video or post you generated with AI, Github link, slides (problem+solution), 2 minute loom/youtube video pitch
- **Questions?** Post in Discord

2. Participant Checklist

👉 Must Haves:

- Laptop
- Charger
- Water bottle
- Good Vibes :)
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3. Code of Conduct

This is a day for building cool stuff, meeting great people, and having fun. Let's keep it that way.

The short version: Be kind, be respectful, don't be a jerk.

The longer version:

We're committed to providing a welcoming and safe experience for everyone, regardless of gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, disability, physical appearance, body size, race, ethnicity, age, religion, nationality, or experience level.

What we expect:

- Treat everyone with respect and kindness — participants, organizers, sponsors, mentors, and judges alike
- Be collaborative. Help each other out.
- Be mindful of your language — both at the venue and on Discord
- Respect personal boundaries and space, especially during overnight hours
- Accept constructive feedback gracefully, whether it's on your code or your pitch
- Ask for consent before taking photos or recording others

What's not okay:

- Harassment of any kind, including unwelcome comments, intimidation, or sustained disruption
- Discriminatory jokes or language, even if "it's just a joke"
- Unwanted physical contact or sexual attention
- Publishing others' private information without permission
- Being destructive with venue property or shared equipment
- Any behavior that makes someone feel unsafe or unwelcome

If you experience or witness anything that makes you uncomfortable, reach out to an organizer — in person at the venue or via DM on Discord. You won't be judged for reporting something, and we'll handle it quickly and discreetly.

Consequences:

Anyone asked to stop unacceptable behavior is expected to stop immediately. Organizers may take any action they deem appropriate, including a warning, removal from the event, or disqualification from judging.

4. Rules

This hackathon is about building and shipping during the weekend.

OK to Bring

- **Ideas, notes, sketches, research** — come prepared with your concept and planning materials
- **Generic starter templates** — boilerplate you reuse for any project (not project-specific)
- **Third-party tools, open source, sponsor tech** — use any tools and libraries (respect licenses)

Not OK

- **A mostly finished product** — no bringing pre-built projects and "just polishing" on-site
- **Project-specific pre-built code** — features built before the hackathon that make up your submission's core

What We Judge

We judge what you build at the hackathon. Projects that are largely pre-built may be penalized in scoring or removed from awards.

Projects will be judged on:

1. Innovation (Is this a new idea or have you seen this before) 30%
2. Real problem solving (is this a real problem worth solving for content creators) 30%
3. Execution (how mature is the solution in its current form) 25%
4. Pitch 15%

First round of judging will be online. Top 8 teams get to present in front of a live jury and audience.

Ownership

All projects built in the hackathon need to be open source. You are free to work on the project after the hackathon.

Best Practices

- **Commit early, commit often** — use git throughout the weekend, create your repo at kickoff
- **Ship a working demo slice early** — get something functional first, then improve. Stability wins.

Teams

- 1-4 people per team
- Recommended: 2-3 — enough to divide work, small enough to move fast

5. Before You Show Up

This is a social media hackathon. Figure out the problem you want to solve. It could be automating a platform such as linkedin, or it could be generating an AI video in a certain style, posting tiktok carousels for your e-commerce page.

Figure out the niche you want to go after.

Some inspiration projects:

1. [MoneyPrinterTurbo](#): Generate tiktok videos with controlled transitions on any topic.
2. [Palmier Pro](#): An opensource video editor.
3. [Postiz](#): Social media scheduler
4. [Socioboard](#): Social media analytics.
5. [Video use](#): Browser use for videos

6. Team Formation

Everyone needs to register individually on luma and form a team at the event.

We highly encourage you to form a team before the event. Use discord to talk to other participants, and start DMing people.

Step 0: Check in on Luma at the front desk

Get your badge, and check in on luma at the desk.

Step 1: Sign up on the hackathon portal

Everyone needs to sign up on the hackathon portal to participate in the hackathon. You can only sign up on the portal after you have been checked in by our staff on luma at the venue.

Step 2: Find a Team

First you need to find a team. You can do this in advance or at the event. There **won't** be a lot of time at the event itself. Team registration on the portal needs to happen at the venue, but you can search for teammates before you arrive.

Step 3: Register team on portal

Only one person from each team needs to register the team on the portal. The person registering the team needs to nominate a team leader. The leader is an administrative role in our view.

Step 4: Claim Perks

Once everyone joins the team and you lock it, your team lead can activate the perks. Let's go!

We recommend everyone claim cursor credits, elevenlabs, fal ai and n8n credits. You can also use all claimed credits after the event.

7. Submission Guide

Required Accounts

Create these before the event:

1. **GitHub** — source code submission
2. **YouTube/Loom** — video demo upload

What You Submit

Submit at hackathon portal:

- 2-minute video (YouTube or other service link)
- Source code on GitHub (repo)
- Pitch deck (url)
- Working demo (url) - optional but encouraged
- If applicable, samples of what you generated

Important: all of them have to be publicly accessible when submitting.

Pitch deck

What to Put in Your Slides (max 5)

Goal: Prove this could help content creators.

this is for inspiration only, you could structure your slides as you wish. just remember, if you get to the finals you will have 3 mins to do the pitch, 2 mins for your demo and 2 mins for Q&A.

Slide 1: The Problem

- who has this problem? (be specific: "busy founders, content creators with more than 50k followers, .." not "businesses")

- how do they solve it today and why does that suck?

Slide 2: Your Solution

- what you built in one sentence
- why is your approach 10x better than alternatives?

(Keep it short. Just enough to understand what it does.)

Slide 3: Sample output/s

- Show us outputs from what you built. This is a social media hackathon. Show, dont tell.

Slide 4: Go-to-Market Plan

Would you use this for yourself?

Would you want to sell this to other creators?

Slide 5: Why You / Why Now

- why are you the right team to build this?
- would you work on this full-time if it got traction?

How You're Evaluated

We judge your project based on how useful it is to a content creator Ship something real.

The further you get on the journey during the hackathon, the more points you earn.

Weight	Category	What We Look For
30%	Real Problem Solving	Does this help content creators in a real way?
30%	Technical Innovation & AI Implementation	Creative use of AI? Strong sponsor tool integration? Novel approach?

Weight	Category	What We Look For
25%	Execution & Working Demo	Does it actually work? How complete? Stable during the demo?
15%	Presentation	Clear problem story? Engaging video? Well-structured pitch?

8. Sponsor Tools & Credits

You are not limited to these tools — you can use any tools, libraries, frameworks, or APIs you want.

Important: Access/claim instructions will be shared separately in Discord and during the event

AI model APIs

fal Fal AI gives you access to a ton of AI models for image and video generation

Building (coding / IDE)

Cursor An AI-powered code editor that helps you write and edit code faster (generate code from instructions, refactor, debug, and iterate quickly). Learn more: cursor.com

Automation & "make it do stuff"

n8n A workflow automation tool that connects apps and services, so you can build flows like “when X happens → do Y → notify Z” without wiring everything manually. Learn more: n8n.io

Voice & audio

ElevenLabs Tools and APIs for generating voice/audio (for example, turning text into speech and building voice experiences). Learn more: elevenlabs.io

Web crawling

Firecrawl: Build crawlers, use it for research and to build directory sites.

9. Catering

Drinks

Please bring your own water bottles which can be filled in the kitchen.

We will also have some drinks available.

Food

We will be providing the following meals:

Saturday: Breakfast, Lunch

10. Quick Reference Card

Key Timeline

Day 1 (Saturday)	Time
Check-in + Breakfast	09:00
Introduction	09:30
Team registration deadline	11:00
Lunch	13:00
Submission deadline	16:30
Top 8 presentation	17:30
Winners announced	19:00

Live Pitch Format: 3 min pitch + 2 min demo + 2 min Q&A